

Build4All Customer Regional and Shipping Policy

Controlled knowledge source for multilingual Text to SQL retrieval

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Authoritative schema	build4all_research
Status	Controlled research source
Scope	Customers, regions, registrations, repeat purchasing, and shipping methods

Purpose and authority

This document defines customer, regional, registration, repeat-purchase, and shipping-method meanings for the frozen build4all_research PostgreSQL schema. It is authoritative for the controlled retrieval experiment and must remain synchronized with the benchmark gold queries.

Customer and order relationships

Each customer is identified by customers.customer_id. An order belongs to a customer through orders.customer_id equals customers.customer_id. Customer region is customers.region. Customer registration time is customers.created_at. Do not use shipping-method geography or order timestamps as substitutes for customer fields.

A recognized order has orders.status equal to completed or shipped. Apply this filter only to metrics that explicitly refer to purchasing customers or recognized orders.

Authoritative customer rules

Purchasing customers by region

A purchasing customer is a customer linked to at least one recognized order. Count distinct customers.customer_id values in each customers.region. Multiple recognized orders by the same customer still count as one purchasing customer within that region.

Monthly customer registrations

Count every customer and group by the calendar month of customers.created_at. Registration counts do not require an order, payment, product, recognized-order filter, or active flag.

Repeat purchasing customers

A repeat purchasing customer has more than one recognized order. First count completed and shipped orders for each orders.customer_id, then count the customers whose recognized-order count is greater than one. Do not count total order rows as the final answer.

Shipping method relationships

An order references its shipping method through `orders.shipping_method_id` equals `shipping_methods.shipping_method_id`. Use `shipping_methods.name` as the human-readable method name. A shipping method may exist even when no order uses it.

Authoritative shipping rules

Order count by shipping method

Count all orders linked to each shipping method. Start from `shipping_methods` and left join orders so that methods with zero related orders remain present. Do not add a recognized-order filter, active-method filter, customer-region filter, or date filter unless the request explicitly requires one.

Recognized shipping amount

Recognized shipping amount by method is governed by the Sales and Order Analytics Policy. It sums `orders.shipping_amount` for orders whose status is completed or shipped. Amount and order-count metrics are different.

Counting and grouping safeguards

- Use `COUNT(DISTINCT customer_id)` for purchasing-customer counts when joins may repeat customers.
- Use `COUNT(order_id)` for shipping-method usage after a direct one-row-per-order join.
- Monthly registration counts use `customers.created_at`, not `orders.order_date`.
- Repeat-customer logic requires a per-customer recognized-order count greater than one.
- Customer region and shipping-method name are separate grouping dimensions.
- Do not add unrelated tables, statuses, active flags, dates, or geographic fields.

Null and reproducibility rules

Preserve null customer regions as a null group unless an approved reporting layer supplies an explicit label. Use a stable secondary order by the displayed region or method name when deterministic output order is needed. Do not infer missing customer regions, shipping methods, registrations, or purchases.

Research governance

This is a synthetic controlled research policy, not an audited production customer or fulfilment policy. Changes to customer identity, regional mapping, recognized-order status, registration time, shipping relationships, or counting rules require a new version and synchronized benchmark updates. Benchmark questions and expected result values are intentionally excluded from this retrieval document.